BERT'S AUTO PARTS SERVICE CENTRE

Traction Staff Manual

Every job the service platform does, in the order you would actually do it. Find your task, follow the numbered steps. Button names in **THIS STYLE** are exactly what you will see on screen.

Front desk · Technicians · Managers Reviewed 13 October 2026

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02 The queue
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COLOUR TELLS YOU WHOSE JOB IT IS

Front desk
Arrivals, walk-ins, appointments, keeping customers informed.

Technician
Your jobs, starting and stopping work, inspections, QC hand-off.

Manager
Reports, staff, bays, services and how the shop is set up.

Everyone
The queue, and what to check when something looks wrong.

ONE VEHICLE, START TO FINISH

Checked in — Front desk issues the ticket
In queue — Arrival order decides
Dispatched — Given a bay and a technician
Being worked on — Technician's clock runs
Quality check — Advisor signs it off
Ready — Customer told it's collectable
Closed — Mileage out, visit closed

FRONT DESK

01 Arrivals & the counter

> The busiest screen in the building. Everything here is built for speed: one search box that takes a phone number, a licence plate or a name, and buttons big enough to hit without looking twice.

Check in a customer who has an appointment

`Operations › Check-In`

1. Type the phone number, licence plate or name into the search box and press Enter.
2. Pick the customer from **Search Results**. Their booked appointment appears with it.
3. Check the vehicle is the one in front of you. If they have brought a different car, pick the right vehicle or add it.
4. Fill in **Intake Details** — mileage, and the oil brand and grade if they have a preference (Castrol, Valvoline, Amsoil, Liqui Moly, or type your own).
5. Confirm the vehicle's **Vehicle Weight**: Light, Standard or Heavy. This decides which bays can take it, so getting it wrong can send the car to a position that cannot lift it.
6. Press the check-in button. A **Ticket Number** is issued and an **Estimated Start** is shown.
7. Read the estimated start to the customer, and offer them the **Customer Status Link**.

> **Two numbers, and only one is the customer's.** The big number on screen is the short one, like `B01-003` — that is what the waiting-room board shows and what the customer should write down. The longer **Reference** underneath is for your own enquiries later. Quote the short one at the counter.

> **On time matters.** An appointment checked in within its protected window keeps its place ahead of the walk-ins. Late, and it joins the queue by arrival time like everyone else.

Register a walk-in

Operations › Check-In

1. Search by phone or plate first — most walk-ins have been here before, and a found record saves you the whole form and keeps their history in one place.
2. If there is genuinely no record, press **CREATE NEW CUSTOMER** and take name, mobile and the vehicle.
3. Under **Walk-In Service Selection**, search the service by name, family or code and tick what they are asking for.
4. Fill in mileage, oil preference and **Vehicle Color** — the colour is what lets you find the right car in a full yard.
5. Set **Vehicle Weight**, then check in. The ticket number is issued and the customer takes their place in the queue by arrival time.

> **Never invent an email address.** Ask for it, but do not type `N/A`, a dash or a made-up address to get past the field — the platform treats a placeholder as a real address and the customer's messages go nowhere. Blank is honest and harmless.

Book an appointment for someone on the phone

Bookings › Appointments › New Appointment

Six short steps, each one a single question:

1. **Customer** — search, or create a new record.
2. **Vehicle** — pick theirs, or add it.
3. **Service request** — what they need.
4. **Date**.
5. **Available time** — what the workshop can take that day.
6. **Review** — read it back to the customer, then confirm.

> If the day is full you get a warning, not a wall. You can still book — the warning is there so you make that choice deliberately, and it is recorded.

> **A staff booking does not need an email address.** Only the customer's own online booking does. If they have no email, book them anyway and tell them you will call.

Give a customer their live status link

`Check-In, or Queue Board › any ticket`

1. Open the ticket and find **Customer Status Link**.
2. Copy it and send it to the customer, or let them scan it.

They then watch their own vehicle move through four stages — **Checked In**, **In Queue**, **In Service**, **Ready** — with no login and without seeing anybody else's details. It is the single best way to stop “is it ready yet?” calls.

Email a customer

`Queue Board › ticket › Customer Communication`

1. Press **EMAIL CUSTOMER**.
2. Choose the message you need — ready for collection, something needed from the customer, a delay, or vehicle due for service.
3. The wording is filled in from the template. Read it. Edit anything that does not fit this customer before you send.
4. Send. The attempt is recorded on the customer's profile and on the visit, whether it succeeded or failed.

> **Email is the only channel.** There is no SMS. If a customer has no email address on file the platform tells you so and stops — add a real address or pick up the phone. Do not fabricate one to force the message through.

Say whether parts are ready

`Queue Board › ticket › Parts Readiness`

Parts and labour live on your existing systems. What this platform needs from you is one honest answer: are the parts for this job here or not?

1. Open the ticket and find **Parts Readiness**.
2. Tick **Acknowledge parts prepositioned** once the parts are physically on hand.

> Until that is ticked the job is **Blocked** and will not be handed to a technician. That is deliberate — it stops a car taking a bay it cannot leave. Never tick it to get a job moving if the parts are not actually there.

Move someone up the queue

`Queue Board › ticket › Set Queue Override`

1. Open the ticket and press **SET QUEUE OVERRIDE**.
2. Give the position and the reason. The reason is required.
3. The ticket shows **Override Active** from then on, and stays pinned where you put it.

> Overrides are recorded against your name. Use them for real reasons — a stranded customer, a vehicle blocking a bay — and expect to be able to explain them.

Handle a no-show or an abandoned vehicle

`Queue Board › ticket`

1. Try the customer first, and log the call on the ticket.
2. If there is no answer and they are not coming, press **MARK NO-SHOW / ABANDONED** and give the reason.

The ticket leaves the live queue, the position is freed, and the record stays so the pattern shows up in reporting later.

Close a visit

`Queue Board › ticket`

1. Check the work is finished and quality-checked, and enter **Mileage Out**.
2. Press **CLOSE VISIT**.

> A visit left open sits in the queue and in the reports for ever, and quietly consumes a slot in tomorrow's availability. Close them the same day.

Log a complaint

Bookings › Complaints › New

1. Record the customer, the subject and what happened, in their words where you can.
2. Set the severity. Every severity carries a response deadline — the severity decides how long you have.
3. Acknowledge it so the customer knows it was received, then work it to **Resolved**.

SEVERITY	RESPOND WITHIN
Critical	4 hours
High	24 hours
Medium	72 hours
Low	120 hours

> Past the deadline the complaint shows as **Overdue** on the list. A manager can change these hours in Settings, so check them against what your shop has agreed. Changing a complaint's severity recalculates the deadline from when it was *logged*, never from now — you cannot buy time by downgrading it.

EVERYONE

02 The queue

> The **Queue Board** is the shared picture of the day. Everyone can see it, it refreshes

> itself every five seconds, and nobody needs to ask anybody else what is going on.

How the order is decided

`Operations › Queue Board`

The queue is **arrival order first**. It is not a scoring system, and nobody's place is quietly recalculated. Four things, in this order, decide the board:

1 **Arrival order**
First checked in, first served. This is the default and it covers most of the day.

2 **On-time appointments jump ahead**
An appointment checked in inside its protected window goes in front of the walk-ins. That is the whole value of booking. Arrive late and the protection is gone.

3 **A manager override pins a position**
Set deliberately, with a reason, by a person. It stays until it is removed.

4 **Blocked work steps aside**
Missing parts, no qualified technician, no suitable bay — the ticket keeps its number but stands out of the way until the block clears. It does not lose its place in line.

> **The ticket number is not the running order.** A ticket number never changes and is what you say to a customer — the short one, the same number the waiting-room board shows. The position on the board moves with the day. Read the position, quote the number.

Read the board

`Operations › Queue Board`

Each row carries the **Ticket**, the customer and vehicle, the **Services** asked for, the **Source** (appointment or walk-in), the **Status**, and how long they have been **Waiting**.

- Labels such as fast-track, late or missed are **descriptions, not instructions**. They tell you what happened; they do not move anyone.
- **Blocked** means the job cannot start yet. Open it and the reason is on the ticket.
- Click any row to open the full ticket, which is where almost every front-desk action lives.

TECHNICIAN

03 On the tools

> One screen, one list, big buttons. The platform asks you for as little admin as it can get away with: start, stop, finished. Everything else is worked out from those three.

Find your work

`Technician › My Jobs`

The screen answers two questions, kept apart on purpose:

- **My Workday** — how your day is going. Time on the clock, jobs **Completed Today**.
- **My Jobs** — what to work on now and next.

Your jobs are always in the same order, so your eye learns it: **Working** → **Up Next** → **Waiting** → **Rework** → **Awaiting QC** → Completed. The registration number leads every card, because that is what you are looking for in the yard.

Start a job

`My Jobs › the card`

1. Find the card, check the registration matches the vehicle in front of you.
2. Press START WORK.

Your clock starts at that moment. The card moves to **Working** and the customer's status page now reads **In Service**.

> **You can only have one job running at a time.** If you try to start a second, the platform stops you and asks what happened to the first. That is what keeps job times honest — two clocks running at once means neither figure is true.

Stop for a hold-up

My Jobs › the working card

1. Press **PAUSE / HOLD-UP**.
2. Pick the reason. For a missing part, choose the parts reason and the button becomes **MARK WAITING FOR PARTS**; otherwise press **CONFIRM PAUSE**.
3. Add a note if there is anything the advisor needs to know.

The clock stops the moment you confirm — **from your timestamp, not from when somebody gets round to acknowledging it**. An advisor or manager then acknowledges the stop. Their acknowledgement does not change your time.

> Pausing honestly is always the right call. The time is held against the hold-up, not against you, and it is the only way the shop can see where its day actually goes.

Get back on a job

My Jobs › the waiting card

1. Press **RESUME WORK**. If it was waiting on a part, the button reads **PARTS ARRIVED — RESUME**.
2. If you have another job running, finish or pause that one first — the same one-at-a-time rule applies on resume.

To move back to a job you stepped away from, use **Back to this job** on its card and say why you are switching.

Finish a job

My Jobs › the working card

1. Press **FINISHED → QC**.

Your clock stops and the job moves to **Awaiting QC**. It is not closed and the customer is not told it is ready — an advisor or manager does the quality check first.

Pick up rework

My Jobs › Rework

If a quality check sends work back, it reappears in your **Rework** group with what needs doing. Start it the same way as any other job. The original work and times are kept — rework is recorded alongside them, not written over them.

Record an inspection

Operations › Inspections

1. Press NEW VEHICLE INSPECTION, or open the vehicle's **Job Sheet**.
2. Work down the checklist. Anything that does not apply can be marked **Skipped** — say so rather than leaving it blank.
3. On the pre-inspection, add photographs where they tell the story better than words. Press TAKE PHOTO and the tablet's camera opens on screen — tap the shutter, then USE PHOTO if it is clear or RETAKE if it is not. Nothing is saved until you choose. UPLOAD IMAGE takes one already on the device instead.
4. Sign off. The record then shows as **Signed off** and cannot be quietly edited.
5. Press ← BACK TO MY JOB at the top. It takes you to the job you opened this from — not to the general Inspections list — and asks first if you have unsaved ticks.

> **The camera needs the secure address.** If the tablet is on a plain `http://` address, the browser will not open the live camera and TAKE PHOTO falls back to the device's own camera app or gallery. Use the `https://` address your manager gave you.

> A saved draft is yours to come back to. Only a signed-off inspection counts as a finding you can show a customer.

Report something, without editing records

Any vehicle you are working on

You have read-only access to a vehicle's history, which is there so you can see what was done last time. If something in the record is wrong, do not try to correct it — add a note on the job saying what you found. An advisor or manager makes the correction, and the trail shows where the information came from.

FRONT DESK & MANAGER

04 Dispatch & the floor

> The **Dispatch Board** is live resource control — who is working, which bays are free, what is stuck, what is waiting on a quality check. It is the screen to leave open on

> the second monitor.

Read the dispatch board

`Operations › Dispatch`

PANEL	WHAT IT IS TELLING YOU
Needs Attention	Anything that needs a person right now. Start here.
Pause Approval Required	A technician has stopped and is waiting for you to acknowledge it.
Needs Dispatch	Checked in, not blocked, waiting for a bay and a technician.
Technician Load	Who is on what, and who is free. Anyone marked absent in Availability shows here too.
Bay & Resource View	Service bays, light-task slots, overflow and power wash, each free, occupied or reserved.
Blocked	Jobs that cannot start, with the reason — usually parts.
Ready for QC	Work a technician has finished, waiting on a quality check.
Overdue	Running past the time the customer was promised. Someone should be calling.

Send the next vehicle in

`Dispatch › Call Next`

1. Press **CALL NEXT**.

The platform takes the next eligible ticket in queue order — skipping anything blocked — and puts it in a bay that suits the vehicle and the work. You do not have to pick; that is the point. Use it as the default way to pull work onto the floor.

Assign a technician yourself

`Dispatch › Needs Dispatch › Assign`

1. Press **ASSIGN** on the card. The full ticket opens.
2. Choose the technician. If they do not hold a skill the services need, the assignment is refused and the message names the missing skill. That is the platform working, not a fault.
3. Choose the bay, or leave it and the platform takes the first compatible free one. Naming a bay whose type does not match the work is refused the same way.
4. For a visit with several orders you can give them all to one technician in one action.

To move a job already underway, use **Reassign technician** on the ticket. Work already done stays credited to the technician who did it.

> **Absence is shown, not enforced.** Marking someone absent in Availability puts them on this board as absent and raises it on the manager's dashboard — but it does not stop you assigning work to them. Check the board before you assign; the platform will not catch this one for you.

Acknowledge a technician's pause

`Dispatch › Pause Approval Required`

1. Read who stopped, why, and since when.
2. Press **APPROVE** to acknowledge it.
3. Press **REJECT** only if the work should not have stopped. A reason is required and the work resumes.

> **Acknowledging never moves the clock.** The stop has been counted from the technician's own timestamp since the moment they confirmed it, so there is no rush and no advantage in being slow. The original request is kept either way.

Do the quality check and finish the order

`Queue Board › ticket`

A job moves through fixed stages, and the button on the ticket always says what pressing it actually does:

STAGE	WHAT YOU CAN DO
Assigned	Nothing here — the technician starts it.
In progress	MARK WORK COMPLETE, or park it as waiting for parts or waiting on the customer.
Waiting	RESUME WORK once the hold-up clears.
Quality check	COMPLETE QUALITY CHECK when the work passes. If it does not, open rework instead.
Ready to invoice	CLOSE ORDER.

> Only once the quality check is complete should the customer be told the vehicle is ready. Sending that email earlier is how a car gets collected mid-job.

Change what a job covers

`Queue Board › ticket › Edit services`

The platform keeps three different things apart on purpose: what the customer **asked for**, what was **approved**, and what was actually **done**. When the customer approves extra work, add it to the order rather than editing the original request — so the record still shows what they came in for.

MANAGER

05 Running the shop

> Visibility first. These screens are for finding the bottleneck and changing how the

> shop runs without anyone touching code.

See the whole floor

`Management › Control Center`

Today's position in one view, with **Quick Actions** through to the screens you reach for most — staff, availability, settings and reports.

Pick the right report

`Management › Reports`

REPORT	ANSWERS
Reports	The overview — throughput and the shape of the day.
Service Mix	What work you are actually selling, by service family.
Technician KPI	Output per technician, on the measures you mapped.
Shared Jobs	Jobs more than one technician touched, so credit is split properly.
Appointments Report	Booked against arrived — on time, late, missed.
Due for Contact	Customers whose vehicles are coming due for service.

> Benchmark and KPI vocabulary belongs here, in management reporting. The operational screens deliberately speak plainly instead — the front desk should never have to decode a metric name mid-shift.

Change how the shop runs

Management › Settings

Every rule the platform follows is a setting, in plain language, with the consequence spelled out. Nothing here needs a redeployment, and every change is recorded with your name and the old value.

GROUP	CONTROLS
Booking & Scheduling	Online booking on or off, notice periods, how far ahead customers may book, closed dates, latest start time, and the Booking Simulator switch.
Capacity & Resources	How many jobs can overlap, and whether capacity comes from a fixed number or from the bays themselves.
Customer Experience	What customers are told, and how estimated times are worked out.
Queue & Arrival Rules	The appointment protection window and how same-day arrivals are handled.
Notifications	Whether email reaches real customers or is held at a test address, plus reminders, consent, service-due reminders and daily follow-ups.
Workshop Operations	Opening hours, job timing, the customer display board, servicing defaults.
Services & Catalogue	Service names, lengths, and which are offered online.
System & Testing	Booking Simulator, bay confirmation, deployment checks, audit logs.

> Settings marked with a consequence change what customers experience immediately. Read the sentence under the control before you move it.

Set up people, bays and services

Setup

SCREEN	USE IT TO
Staff	Add people, set their role, set passwords, record skills. **Edit name** corrects how someone is recorded — several technicians were entered as an initial and surname ("J. Walters"), which is why their welcome screen showed only an initial. Enter the first and last name and the greeting follows.
Availability	A weekly calendar of who is working: available, on break, off the floor or absent.
Assignments	Every technician job assignment in one list, for checking who has what.
Resources & Bays	What each position is and what it can take — weight, vehicle class, type of work, and its **Physical position** in the floor's own words ("Position 3", "Wash area"). Lift types now include two-post and drive-on runway. **Confirm Work Positions** shows the workshop layout as numbered on the photographs, with each slot's linked record or "No record linked" — typing a position onto a record is how it gets linked; nothing is linked by matching codes. The **Vehicle Wash Bay** takes washing only: a vehicle moves there after its mechanical work by releasing the lift first, and the wash holds one car at a time.
Services	The catalogue: names, how long each takes, required skill and bay, and whether customers may book it online.
Performance / KPI Mapping	Define what counts as output before you read the KPI report.
Notifications	The customer email templates — subject, body, and the placeholders that get filled in.

> **Placeholders in templates.** Anything in double braces is replaced with the real customer's details when the email goes out. Edit the wording around them freely; never retype or translate a placeholder, or that part of the message arrives blank.

Check what happened, and why

`Setup › Audit Logs`

Every override, every settings change, every acknowledged pause, every closed visit, with who and when. This is the first place to look when two people remember a day differently.

`Setup › Data Review` is the related screen for cleaning up historical records imported from the old system — visits whose customer could not be matched automatically.

Try something without touching real data

`Setup › Booking Simulator`

Two jobs, both useful when a customer says a time “should” be available:

1. Pick a service and a date range and run the simulation. Every slot comes back with the reason it is or is not offered — capacity, opening hours, notice period, bay type.
2. Start a test booking session to walk the real customer booking flow. Anything it creates is tagged as test data and its emails are captured rather than sent.

> This is a setup tool. If you would rather it were not on the menu at all, switch it off at `Settings › Booking & Scheduling › Testing tools` and it disappears — screen, menu entry and all. Turning it back on is the same one switch.

FRONT DESK & MANAGER

06 What customers see

> Four things reach customers. Knowing exactly what is on each one saves a lot of

> explaining at the counter.

Online booking

`/book — no login`

Five plain steps: **Let's find you → What do you need? → Pick a time → A few details → Please confirm**. Nothing is held until they confirm, and only times the workshop can genuinely take are shown.

- They identify themselves with their mobile number plus licence plate. New customers enter the same two things and a record is created.
- What they tell the booking form goes straight onto the job sheet, so they are not asked again on arrival.
- **Online booking does require an email address**, because the confirmation and the manage link have nowhere else to go. Booking at the desk does not.

The manage link in their confirmation

`Sent with the booking confirmation email`

Their confirmation email carries a private link that lets them reschedule or cancel on their own, up to the cutoff you set in Settings. It is single-purpose and expires — it is not an account and it shows them nothing but their own booking.

> If a customer says the link does not work, it has most likely expired or already been used. Make the change for them at the desk.

The waiting-room screen

`Settings › Workshop Operations › Customer display board`

1. Get the display address from `Settings › Workshop Operations › Customer display board`.
2. Open it on the waiting-room screen and leave it. No login, and it refreshes itself.

It shows three columns — **Waiting**, **In Service**, **Ready** — and each vehicle leads with its **licence plate**, with the short ticket number underneath, because a customer recognises their car before they remember a number. A car being checked shows as **Quality Check**. The estimated completion appears only when the platform has one; it never invents a time. No names, no phone numbers, nothing else: it is a public screen in a public room.

- A vehicle with no plate recorded says *No plate recorded* and goes by its ticket number.
- A **Ready** car drops off the screen after a few hours (set under the same display settings), so one collected without its visit being closed does not sit there all day.
- If management would rather not show full plates, **Mask Licence Plates** in the same settings shows only the last three characters — enough to find your own car, not enough to read anyone else's.

> The address contains a private token. Do not post it anywhere public. If it leaks, a manager can change the token in the same setting and the old address stops working.

Emails they receive

`Setup › Notifications`

Email is the only channel. Every message is a template you can edit, and every send is recorded against the customer and the visit:

- Booking confirmation, and reminders before the appointment.
- Vehicle ready for collection.
- Something is needed from the customer, or a delay.
- Vehicle due for service.

> Operational messages about a vehicle in your care are always sent. Marketing is the only kind that depends on consent, and an imported record with no answer recorded counts as **unknown**, not as a refusal.

> **Check whether email is actually going out.** Under `Settings › Notifications › Where customer email goes`, the **Send Email to Customers** switch decides whether messages reach real customers or are held at a test address while you check the wording. While it is off, every send still looks successful on screen and is recorded — it simply went to the test address, not the customer. Look here first if a customer says they were never told.

EVERYONE

07 When it looks wrong

> Most of these are the platform doing its job rather than failing at it. Check here

> before escalating.

Common things, explained

`Read the row, then the ticket`

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT IT MEANS
A job will not start	Parts not acknowledged, no qualified technician on shift, or no suitable bay. Open the ticket — the reason is on it.
“One job at a time” when starting work	Working as intended. Finish or pause the job already on your clock.
An assignment is refused	The technician lacks a skill the services need, or the named bay is the wrong type. The message says which.
A time the customer wants is not offered	Run it through the Booking Simulator — it names the exact rule, usually notice period, latest start or capacity.
The email button refuses	No real email address on file. Add one, or call instead. Do not enter a placeholder.
A customer says they never got the email	Check Settings › Notifications: if **Send Email to Customers** is off, it went to the test address instead. The send still shows as successful.
Waiting times look impossible	Almost always an old visit nobody closed. Check for open visits from previous days.
A ticket's position moved	An on-time appointment arrived, or a manager set an override. The ticket number itself never changes.
A screen in this manual is not in your menu	Your role does not have it. Ask your manager if you need it.

Habits worth keeping

`Every shift`

- **Close visits the same day.** Open visits distort the queue, the waiting times and tomorrow's availability.
- **Search before you create.** A duplicate customer splits their history in two.
- **Never type a placeholder into a contact field.** Blank is honest; fake is worse than nothing.
- **Pause honestly.** Held time is counted against the hold-up, not the technician.
- **Give a reason on an override.** You will be asked about it eventually, and the record is what answers for you.

Bert's Service Operations Platform — one platform, one queue, one record of what happened.

Something in here no longer matches the screen? Tell your manager, who can have the manual corrected. A manual nobody trusts is worse than no manual.